

Project title: Tagalong

My pair partner: Majed al-Sakkaf

Tool we had to use: API + python code

What problem does it solve, and for whom? Name a real, specific user. "Everyone" is not a user.

- **Problem:** Low-income young adults experience social exclusion because social activities are financially out of reach, while available financial support (discounts, free programs) goes unclaimed due to a lack of awareness (SDG 10, Target 10.2).
- **Target User:** A young adult aged 18–27 living on a low income in the Den Haag region who wants to socialize with friends but struggles to find affordable activities or navigate available local support programs.
- *For example: Maya, a 21-year-old student living in Den Haag on a tight monthly income who turns down outings with friends because she cannot afford them and does not know which local youth discounts she qualifies for.*

Research:

- **CBS — Youth Poverty Statistics:**
 - National level: CBS data shows that 3.1% to 3.6% of youth live in households under the poverty threshold.
 - Den Haag level: Urban centers face higher rates, with over 12% of children and young people growing up in low-income families.
 - Source: *CBS — Armoede en risico op armoede*
- **Nibud — Financial Stress Among Youth:**
 - Nibud research reveals that 1 in 5 young adults aged 18–26 face severe financial stress or payment issues.
 - Impact: Leisure activities, culture, and outings are the first expenses cut when budgets are tight, driving social isolation.
 - Source: *Nibud — Rapport Geldstress bij jongeren*
- **SCP — Social Exclusion & Non-Participation:**
 - Participation Gap: SCP identifies financial strain as the primary cause of social exclusion. Over 40% of low-income youth miss out on regular social activities due to cost.
 - Unclaimed Support: Many eligible young adults miss available financial support (like municipal discount passes) simply due to a lack of awareness.
 - Source: *SCP — Armoede en Sociale Uitsluiting*

Which SDG does it address and why?

- SDG 10 — Reduced Inequalities, specifically Target 10.2 (promoting social, economic, and political inclusion of all, irrespective of economic status).
- Why it addresses it:
 - Removes Financial Barriers to Participation: Low-income young adults (aged 18–27) often drop out of social life due to cost. The tool directly combats economic exclusion by matching users with free or budget-friendly local activities, ensuring social inclusion is accessible regardless of income.
 - Bridges the Information Gap on Public Support: Municipal financial aid and discount programs (like the *Ooievaarspas* or *CJP*) exist specifically to reduce inequality but frequently go unclaimed due to a lack of awareness. By surfacing these support systems with direct verification links, the tool turns existing social safety nets into actual participation.

What did you build? Two or three sentences. What can a user actually do with it?

- **What we built:** A Streamlit Python app using the Claude API and live web search to connect low-income youth in Den Haag with verified local discounts and activities, strictly dropping any price or eligibility claim that lacks a source link.
- **What a user can do:**
 - Enter their total budget, personal interests, and group size.
 - See financial support options they likely qualify for (e.g., *Ooievaarspas*, *CJP*) with direct links to verify.
 - Get a tailored list of current local events/activities complete with date, price per person, total budget breakdown, and source links.
 - Generate and copy a ready-to-send group invite text for their friends.

Link to the live thing (if any): Deployed URL, workflow export, video demo - whatever proves it works.

- GitHub Repository: github.com/nemoyrolls/meedoen (renaming to *outtogether-ai*)
- Demo Video: [Link to 2-minute demo recording]
- Deployed App: [Link to live Streamlit app URL]

Who did what? Be honest about the split of work between you and your partner.

- **Majed:** Handled all technical development, including the Python codebase, Streamlit UI, Claude API integration, budget calculation logic, and handling edge cases.
- **Ana:** Led research and documentation, including docs/research.md (youth poverty data from CBS, Nibud, SCP), the project README, the ethical reflection, slides, and the 2-minute demo video.